

Parker McClain

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EDUCATION

MASSACHUSETTS INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

B.S. Chemical Engineering, Minor in Chemistry (4.5/5.0); Varsity Football

Cambridge, MA
Expected May 2028

AWARDS

36 ACT	June 2022
National Merit Scholar	May 2024
National Football Foundation Scholar Athlete	May 2024
Tennessee Football All State (2x)	November 2022 & 2023
Downbeat Magazine's Best Highschool Blues, Pop, and Rock Band (Group; 2x)	June 2022 & 2023

WORK EXPERIENCE

LYLA BIOSCIENCES (STARTUP)

Co-Founder

Cambridge, MA
January 2026 – Present

- Built an iOS app that integrates with Apple Health. Planning to launch after legal review.
- Secured **venture funding from MIT** sandbox program, pitched ideas to investors, created a website (lylabiosciences.com), currently working with lawyers to meet legal standards and conducting customer discovery interviews. **Co - designed a proprietary machine learning algorithm** to predict the impact of lifestyle on blood sugar.

PLATA LAB

Undergraduate Researcher

Cambridge, MA
Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

- Designed and executed experiments on the degradation kinetics of biodegradable plastic.
- Collected over 1,400 Total Organic Carbon and LC-MS measurements on 488 unique samples. Created degradation model for biodegradable polymers; findings submitted to American Chemical Society (2nd Author).

TEACHING

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant

Cambridge, MA
September 2025 – Present

- Led weekly problem solving sessions for 12 undergraduate MIT students in MIT's largest course. My section constantly had the highest average in the class of over 1,000 students across the two midterms.
- Hosted organic chemistry office hours beginning in January 2026.

ACTIVITIES AND PROJECTS

VARSITY FOOTBALL

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Cambridge, MA
Aug 2024 – Present

- Spent upwards of 20 hours each week lifting weights, practicing, watching film, and competing with the MIT Varsity Football team. Contributed as a starter to the teams best season since 2019.

RUSH CHAIR, DELTA KAPPA EPSILON

January 2026 - Present

- Led recruitment for 50 member organization by designing and scheduling 15 unique recruiting events. Managed \$13,000 budget and a committee of 3 people to conduct a multi-week recruiting cycle. Contributed to 17 person recruitment class; largest since before 2015.

DRUMMER, AMERICAN MUSIC ENSEMBLE AND THE DEUCE

Aug 2020 - Present

- Led the St. George's AME rhythm section. Helped the band earn recognition as the "Best Highschool Blues, Pop, Rock" band in the Nation twice (Downbeat Magazine 2022, 2023). Currently play drums for The Deuce and opened for Dayglow at their MIT concert.

SKILLS

Technical Skills: Python, Java, CSS, HTML, JavaScript, Swift, Laboratory Skills (TOC, LC-MS, GC-MS, ICP-MS), Solidworks

Interests: Music; Snowboarding; Sailing; Jiu-Jitsu; Baking Bread; and Good Coffee